

HEATING & COOLING · EDUCATIONAL OVERVIEW

Potential HVAC Upgrade Option for This Home

Efficient whole-home heating and cooling — without existing ductwork.

Considering Central Air?

Homes without existing ductwork can be difficult and costly to fit for traditional central air. A **ductless mini-split system** may offer an alternative worth exploring. A mini-split pairs one compact outdoor unit with one or more slim indoor units, delivering both **heating and cooling** year-round. Because refrigerant lines run through a small opening rather than bulky ducts, **no existing ductwork is required**—which can make it a practical consideration for older homes. Whether it is the right fit here depends on the property and should be confirmed by a licensed contractor.



No Existing Ductwork Needed

Installs where ducts don't exist or aren't practical.



Energy Efficient

Inverter heat-pump technology can lower energy use.



Individual Room Control

Set each zone's temperature independently.



Minimal Disruption

Typically installed in a day or two with little demolition.



Quiet Operation

Indoor units run softly—often near a whisper.

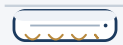


Great Retrofit for Ranch Homes

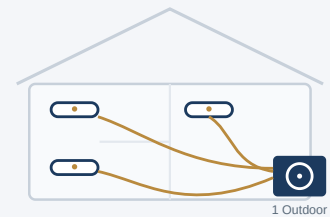
Often an excellent fit for older single-story layouts.



OUTDOOR
CONDENSER



INDOOR WALL
UNIT



ONE OUTDOOR UNIT · MULTIPLE
INDOOR ZONES

Typical Installed Costs — Chicago Area

CONFIGURATION	WHAT IT COMMONLY SERVES	TYPICAL INSTALLED RANGE
Single Zone	One room or open area — e.g., a primary bedroom or living room	\$2,500 – \$7,000
Three Zones	Several rooms on one system — common for a small home or main level	\$7,000 – \$12,000
Four Zones	Whole-home coverage across four separate areas	\$9,000 – \$18,000

Pricing varies with equipment brand, efficiency (SEER2), line-set length, electrical work, permits, and site conditions. Figures are general estimates for illustration only, not a quote.

Popular Manufacturers



Mitsubishi Electric
mitsubishicomfort.com



Daikin
daikincomfort.com



Fujitsu (AIRSTAGE)
fujitsugeneral.com/us



LG
lg.com/us/residential-hvac

Scan a code to explore each manufacturer's official ductless line-up. Listed alphabetically by category; not an endorsement.

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER

This information is provided solely for general educational purposes to illustrate one potential HVAC upgrade option. Bons Realty and its agents are not licensed HVAC contractors and make no representation or warranty regarding suitability, installation feasibility, costs, savings, permits, or code compliance. Buyers should obtain an independent evaluation and written estimate from a qualified, licensed HVAC contractor.

SOURCES & REFERENCES

- U.S. Dept. of Energy, "Ductless Mini-Split Heat Pumps," energy.gov — system operation, efficiency, and zoning.
- EnergySage, "How Much Does a Mini-Split Cost?" (2025) — single-zone installed-cost ranges.
- HomeGuide & Angi mini-split cost guides (2025–2026) — multi-zone installed-cost ranges.
- Carrier / manufacturer cost guides — per-zone pricing and installation factors.
- Manufacturer sites: mitsubishicomfort.com, daikincomfort.com, fujitsugeneral.com, lg.com.
- ENERGY STAR, "Ductless Heating & Cooling," energystar.gov — efficiency & comfort benefits.